

Week 9 — Lab Handout (Student)

Reviewing Code (Especially the AI's)

Time: ~90 min in-class **Work as:** Your team (5 members) **AI use this week:** ✓ On — but this week AI's output is what you're reviewing. Log prompts. **What you leave with:** Reviewed, sign-off-gated PRs and sharper eyes for AI's mistakes.

Why this lab matters

This is the skill that makes everything else safe. You can generate code fast — the value now is knowing whether it's actually right. Today you review each other's work against a checklist, hunt planted bugs in AI-generated snippets, and lock in the rule that carries you to the finish: nothing merges without a peer sign-off and a green test suite.

Task 1 — Open an AI-assisted PR (15 min)

- ☐ Pick a small feature or fix. Use AI to help write it.
- ☐ Open a pull request; attach your prompt log to the PR description.
- ☐ Make sure the automated tests run against it.

Task 2 — Review a teammate's PR with the checklist (25 min)

Review someone else's PR against every item:

- ☐ **Correctness** — right behavior, edge cases, error paths?
- ☐ **Readability** — clear names, sensible structure?
- ☐ **Consistency** — matches team patterns and the standard response/error shapes?
- ☐ **Security** — validation present, no injection, no committed secrets?
- ☐ **Tests** — present and meaningfully asserting?
- ☐ Leave at least one **substantive** comment (not just "LGTM").

Task 3 — Find the flaw (20 min)

Your instructor will provide AI-generated snippets with planted bugs (or generate your own and swap with another team).

- ☐ For each snippet, find and document the flaw(s): what's wrong, why, and the fix.
- ☐ Aim to catch: missing validation, wrong status codes, unhandled 404/500, hallucinated methods, missing edge cases.
- ☐ Record findings in `/docs/find-the-flaw.md`.

Task 4 — Practice good feedback (10 min)

- ☐ Rewrite each review comment to be **specific, kind, and actionable**.
- ☐ Label each as **blocking** (must fix) or **nit** (optional).
- ☐ Note at least one thing the code did well.

Task 5 — Enforce the merge rule (10 min)

- ☐ No PR merges without **passing tests + one approving review**.
- ☐ Address review comments, re-request review, then merge.
- ☐ Confirm branch protection is blocking un-reviewed merges.

End-of-Lab Checklist

- ☐ Each member opened at least one reviewed PR with a prompt log
- ☐ Each member gave at least one substantive review with a blocking/nit label
- ☐ `/docs/find-the-flaw.md` — documented bugs found in AI snippets
- ☐ No un-reviewed, red-suite merges this week
- ☐ Prompt logs current in `/docs/ai-notes/week-09.md`

Looking ahead to Week 10

Feature freeze. You stop building and start breaking — a full manual QA pass, a test matrix, adversarial testing, and a triaged bug list to fix before you ship.